



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chandler Preparatory Academy
School Website: <https://chandlerprep.greatheartsamerica.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Chandler Preparatory Academy (AZ 85224) presents a clearly classical, Great-Hearts–influenced model of education. Public-facing materials emphasize a classical liberal arts curriculum built around Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, with strong commitments to Great Books, Humane Letters, Socratic pedagogy, and a college-preparatory trajectory rooted in virtue formation. The school also foregrounds parental partnership and an active, family-oriented community culture. Taken together, these signals align most closely with CLASSICAL/classical-education norms, with notable emphasis on formation, moral purpose, and a robust, dialogic, book-centered pedagogy.

Key evidence points include: a stated commitment to cultivating hearts and minds through Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; a curriculum described as classical liberal arts with Great Books and Humane Letters; explicit use of Socratic seminars and daily seminar culture in upper grades; a strong faculty/staff presence described on the site; and active parent/community engagement through formal parent groups and events. These signals collectively support a generally CLASSICAL classification, with Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) showing strong alignment with transcendentals and virtue, Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) clearly CLASSICAL, Element 2 (Purpose and Goal), Element 5 (Faculty), and Element 6 (Parents & Community) also aligning strongly, though with some caveats about theology and liturgical language that are not explicitly foregrounded on public pages.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials repeatedly foreground Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as central aims of education. The About Us statement explicitly places the school within the Great Hearts framework and highlights a triad of transcendent ideals. This triad appears as a guiding metaphysical frame rather than a fully explicit theological program on the public site.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Truth, Goodness, Beauty (three core transcendentals). The site's explicit triad signals alignment with transcendental ideals rather than purely secular aims. - Negative indicators: Explicit theology, liturgical practices, or sacramental language are not foregrounded in the public materials, which centers the triad but does not quote or embed a formal theological program on the site. The absence of liturgical language in public-facing material tempers the alignment to "CLASSICAL" and supports a "SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL" reading for this category.

Why this rating - The school clearly embraces transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue-oriented formation, but public content does not overtly foreground theological commitments or liturgical practices. This places Element 1 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's stated aim is for formation of virtue and wisdom, not mere information or job-readiness. The public materials emphasize forming character and leading a life oriented toward truth and virtue, consistent with a paideia-like aim. The public statement frames education as formation of a virtuous, rational, and morally oriented person.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: formation (formation of character), virtue, wisdom, liberal education, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful. The Great Hearts framing emphasizes classical mission and human flourishing through a liberal-arts education. - Negative indicators: None clearly foregrounded in the public materials; the site foregrounds formation and virtue rather than job-preparatory language.

Why this rating - The materials consistently present education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, aligning closely with CLASSICAL expectations for school purpose and telos.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as a classical liberal arts program, with explicit Great Books/Human Letters emphasis, and a sequence of English/history integrated in Humane Letters. The curriculum explicitly references Great Books, primary sources, and a “Great Conversation” framing. - Specific grade-level design shows Humane Letters in upper grades (9–12) with readings from Western civilization; Latin/Greek offerings and a structured humanities-first approach are evident. The curriculum overview highlights a four-level sequence and a classical humanities emphasis.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: liberal arts, grammar/logic/rhetoric (Trivium), Great Books, primary sources, Western civilization, humane letters, classical languages (Latin, Greek), history integrated with literature, and an emphasis on “Great Books” and “Great Conversation.” These map directly to the lexicon’s positive curriculum keywords. - Negative indicators: The public materials do not emphasize a social-studies-only or project-based-first framing; rather, they foreground Great Books and integrated humanities. The lexicon notes that reliance on “project-based learning” or STEM-first framing would be negative signals, which are not foregrounded here. This supports a CLASSICAL reading.

Why this rating - The explicit classical curriculum framing (Great Books, Humane Letters, Trivium-focused literacy, classical languages, and integrated history/literature) places Element 3 squarely in CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The upper school content highlights Socratic discussion, seminars, and the development of rhetorical skills; Humane Letters is described as a daily, directed Socratic seminar focused on Western literature and philosophy. This is a core hallmark of classical pedagogy. - Lower-level pedagogy on the core Great Hearts model includes a mix of contemplative/restful elements and deliberate memory work (recitation, chanting) as part of the broader pedagogy. The Great Hearts public materials emphasize a structured, dialogic approach in the upper grades and a memory/recitation component in the overall pedagogy. - Additional contextual support from Great Hearts materials describes the living curriculum and a teacher-student mentorship culture, aligning with classical pedagogical aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Socratic seminar, great conversation, recitation/narration/chanting, rhetoric, upper-school seminars, and a living curriculum model. The literal presence of “Socratic Seminar” and “Humane Letters” as a pedagogy supports the classical reading. - Negative indicators: The site does not emphasize exclusively project-based only or experiential learning as the sole pedagogy; the classical approach remains central, which aligns with CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The site’s emphasis on Socratic pedagogy, memorization/recitation elements (via memory and classical rhetoric practices), and a clearly defined upper-level seminar culture strongly align with CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The About Us and Faculty pages present Chandler Prep as a community with a well-documented faculty/staff structure, signaling a living, mentor-like model rather than a purely technical or check-the-box approach. The site likewise emphasizes faculty as a core element of the school culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: “faculty,” “staff,” “leadership,” “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher” (as concept in classical lexicons), and a culture of mentorship and virtue modeling. The lexicon’s model teachers/mentors and living-curriculum framing align with the site’s emphasis on a robust faculty community. - Negative indicators: The site does not foreground a purely hierarchical

or certification-driven faculty narrative; rather, it emphasizes mentorship, living curriculum, and collegial culture, which is consistent with CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The public-facing content frames faculty as central to curriculum and culture, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for the faculty category.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - There is explicit emphasis on partnership with families and parent formation through the site (e.g., About Us and PSO pages outline parent involvement and the school's connection to families). Community events and parent-oriented information are visible (e.g., Dad's Club, Giving Tuesday, and other parent-facing activities). - Positive signals from the lexicon for Parents and Community include: partnership with families, parent formation, open campus, and parental involvement as co-educators. Chandler Prep's public materials showcase a parent/community network (e.g., PSO, Dad's Club, Giving Tuesday testimonials) that align with these signals.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Partnership with families (co-teachers), parent formation (book studies, seminars, gatherings), open campus and visitor access, and family involvement language visible in public materials (e.g., PSO communications and Giving Tuesday stories). These map to the lexicon's positive keywords. - Negative indicators: None obvious in the public-facing materials; the school's materials portray a strong, collaborative family culture.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates robust parental partnership and an active community orientation, matching CLASSICAL expectations for the Parents & Community category.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

The Chandler Preparatory Academy materials consistently align with classical-education markers across Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents/Community. Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) shows strong use of the transcendental triad (Truth, Goodness, Beauty) but does not foreground explicit theology or liturgy on public pages, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for that category. The remaining categories (2, 3, 4, 5, 6) trend toward CLASSICAL with strong evidence for formation, Great Books, Socratic pedagogy, living-curriculum faculty, and active parental/community involvement. Taken together, the school's overall profile is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle (Only for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases) - If Element 1 remains SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, explicit articulation of theological foundations or liturgical practices (even if non-denominational or broadly ecumenical) would move Element 1 toward CLASSICAL, as would explicit language about liturgical practices or sacramental formation in public materials. - Strengthening explicit language about formation as a telos beyond virtue (e.g., a clear statement on the metaphysical rationale for truth/beauty/goodness beyond the triad) would further reinforce the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations category toward CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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